

Example 1

In order to better understand why some museums are more proactive than others in regards to the process of repatriating Native American artifacts, I focus on how variation in museum mission statement language leads to variation in repatriation compliance. To first situate this hypothesis, one must consider the role of the mission statement in public agencies. Stoffle and Evans (1994) find that positive or negative outcomes in regards to repatriation are largely affected by whether museums choose to value an artifacts scientific importance or choose to emphasize their social and religious cultural values. As Weiss and Piderit (1999) demonstrate, mission statements are fruitful for determining the values of an organization. Weiss and Piderit (1999) analyzed the content and rhetorical style of mission statements from over three hundred public schools and concluded that mission statements provide opportunity for positive academic performance but is essentially an expression of the will of the upper-level managers of the organization. In addition, compliance may also have positive consequences for organizations.

Bradley (2018) finds that adherence and deliberate attention to NAGPRA repatriation requests can be used to elevate the credibility of a museum. Perezts and Picard (2015) illustrate the importance of managers' ethics when dealing with issues of compliance. Wright, Moynihan, and Pandey (2011) find that transformational leadership as an organizational principle influences mission valence - the reach and role of the organization's mission in attracting employees to the organization. This leaves us with the question: is the mission statement a more reliable indicator or positive repatriation requests or is it the discretion of the upper management? Measuring the 'performance' of museums under the Native America Graves Protection and Repatriation Act of 1990 (NAGPRA) stipulations by investigating their mission statements could provide insight as to how to understand the role of the mission statement in the reasoning behind an organization's cooperation, ambivalence, or recalcitrance toward repatriation.

Example 2

Scholars have demonstrated a relationship between academic and vocational correctional education programs, and reduced recidivism rates as well as increased employment opportunities. Recidivism includes, but is not limited to, reoffending, rearrests, reconviction, parole violation, and/or reincarceration. Here, I define recidivism as reincarceration. Correctional education refers to a variety of educational programs for incarcerated individuals, including but not limited to, Adult Basic Education (ABE) which offers basic skills training in math, reading, and writing, Vocational Education to help train or prepare individuals for general positions of employment or skills specific for employment in certain industries, Post-Secondary Correctional Education (PSCE) encompassing advanced college coursework, and even Arts-In-Corrections programs which include writing poetry, drawing, painting, and more.

Researchers at RAND Corporation found that inmates who participated in programs had 43 percent lower odds of recidivating and 13 percent higher odds in obtaining employment upon release than their counterparts (Davis, Lois, et al., 2013). One study found that correctional education participants had a 21 percent re-incarceration rate whereas non-participants had a 31 percent re-incarceration rate, and participants had significantly higher wages than non-participants (Steurer & Smith, 2003). Researchers found that participants in a postsecondary correctional education program were more likely to be employed upon release, and less likely to recidivate (Armstrong, et al., 2012). Additionally, WSD participants earned higher wages per quarter upon release than those who did not complete the vocational training program (Armstrong, et al., 2012).

The work demonstrates that employment upon release is a key component in the successful reintegration of offenders and that participation in these programs is key for lowering recidivism. By providing educational access to inmates, taxpayer dollars are saved, and recidivism rates are reduced (Davis, Lois, et al. 2013). The need for education amongst this population is transparent and correctional educational programs are important contributors in reducing recidivism.

(Long) Example 3

Whyte (1980) argued that the social life of public spaces such as parks can contribute to the quality of life of individuals and society. A study of park perception, by the National Recreation and Park Association (2015), confirms that American's find parks provide social as well as physical and mental health benefits. These sources demonstrate the need for quality public parks and park visitation in our cities. Yet, research has illustrated that parks are not used simply because they are available. A review of the literature of park use indicates that park characteristics such as crime, proximity, size, maintenance, as well as programming and outreach relate to park use (Baran et al. 2014; Banda et al, 2014; Cohen, Han, Derosé et al, 2012; Loukaitou-sideris & Sideris, 2009).

Though much research has identified relationships between urban design, playgrounds, acreage and park use, evidence on the relationship between public restroom accessibility and park visitation is severely limited, especially in the United States. This research gap can be explained by the competing demands of the growing field of urban planning as well as our social taboos around bodily waste that prevent us from productively engaging on the topic in the country (Neuman and Smith, 2013; Greed, 2003; Kira, 1977). Anthony and Dufresne's (2007) research also suggests that the topic is understudied because representation of women, older people and people with disabilities in urban planning and architecture is inadequate. These representation issues allow inequities related to the needs of these special populations to persist. Greed (2003), Anthony, and Dufresne (2007) agree that the unavailability of public restrooms is a significant gender inequity because adult women not only have more biological needs or social expectations to use the restroom more than men, they are also more likely to be caregivers for children or older adults who have more biological needs as well.

Moreover, restroom scholars suggest that the number of toilets in public spaces control visitation and the amount of time that people can stay at a site, especially for young and adult women, children, individuals with disabilities, and older adults (Kitchin and Law, 2001; Greed, 2003; I'DGO, 2007). Studies conducted in Greater Manchester, Brecon and London found that good facilities, including the existence of toilets predicted the amount of time participants spent outdoors, either walking or pursuing other activities, such as gardening (I'DGO, 2007). Researchers in England have also concluded that public toilets are a missing link to increasing transit ridership there (Bichard, Hanson, & Greed, 2013). Scholars also agree that sanitary conditions and signage relate to the usage of a restroom and its associated public space, such as a park (Anthony and Dufresne, 2007; Ramster, Bichard, 2011). Issues regarding homelessness and street feces have renewed interest on the topic of public restroom availability (Los Angeles Central Providers Collaborative & Skid Row Community Residents and Partners, 2017; Smith, 2019). A San Francisco Pit Stop Restroom Program is successfully using paid attendants to monitor restrooms on city sidewalks. Though, numbers regarding usage of the associated public space were not gathered before and after pit stop implementation, the research suggests that its additions improved the neighborhoods by reducing feces from the street and making it a more enjoyable place to visit and spend longer periods of time (San Francisco Public Works, n.d). The San Francisco program has become a national model for other cities such as Miami, Denver and Sacramento, Los Angeles (San Francisco Public Works, 2018).

In contrast, Mitchell's (2003) research on social justice and public space analyzes how increasing public restrooms access in parks could also trigger "broken window syndrome" for park users. Amenities that can be accessed by people experiencing homelessness such as park restrooms or benches have proven contentious local planning implementation activities because communities perceive that people experiencing homelessness will cause them "harm" or safety concerns. His research suggests that restroom availability that allows people experiencing homelessness to enter a park for restroom access may decrease parks users or the length of their stay due to perceived safety threats or comfortability.